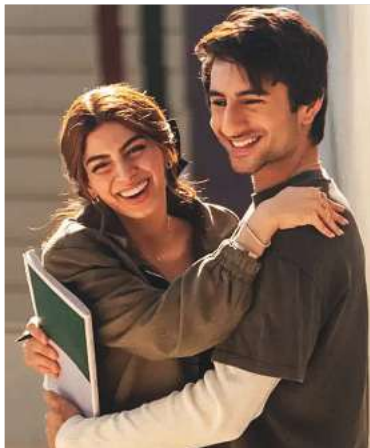


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ENTERTAINMENT | P16
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THE VIEWS | P8
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FRIDAY TAKEAWAY | P10-11
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Grace period to update tax records to end soon

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The Federal Tax Authority (FTA) has reminded UAE businesses to update their tax records before the predetermined grace period ends on March 31 to avoid penalties.

The UAE Cabinet introduced a grace period last year, allowing registrants to update their tax records without penalties if done between January 1, 2024, and the end of this month.

Businesses must ensure that details such as their name, address, email, trade licence activities, legal status, and business locations are accurate, the authority urged, while also adding that any changes should be reported to the FTA within 20 business days using the approved process.

"If businesses update their records during the grace period, any previously imposed fines will be waived and reimbursed. The initiative aims to support businesses, simplify tax procedures, and strengthen the national economy," it said.

The FTA stressed that this decision was made to continue supporting taxpayers and encouraging them to comply with tax procedures and legislation.

Putin backs Ukraine ceasefire idea, but has 'serious questions'

VERY DISAPPOINTING MOMENT FOR WORLD IF DEAL REJECTED, TRUMP WARNS

MOSCOW

Russian President Vladimir Putin said yesterday he backed the idea of a truce with Ukraine, but said he had "serious questions" about how it would be implemented that he wanted to discuss with Donald Trump.

He was responding to a joint US-Ukrainian plan for a 30-day ceasefire in Ukraine that US special envoy Steve Witkoff is due to present to Russian officials later in the day.

The US negotiators will present their plan, even as Washington pushes Moscow for an "unconditional" pause to the three-year conflict.

"We agree with proposals to cease hostilities, but on the basis that that cessation would lead to long-term peace and addresses the root causes of the crisis," Putin told a press conference in Moscow.

"But there are nuances," he said.

Forces advancing

Putin said Russian troops were advancing in practically all areas of the front line, and that Moscow would decide its "next steps" based on his forces' success in kicking Ukrainian troops out of Kursk.

"If we stop hostilities for 30 days, what does that mean?



AFP

■ In this handout footage released by the Kremlin yesterday, Russian President Vladimir Putin visits a command point for the Kursk group of troops involved in the counter-offensive in the Kursk region.

That everyone who is there will go out without a fight?... How will supervision (of the ceasefire) be organised? These are all serious questions.

"I think we need to talk to our American colleagues... Maybe have a phone call with President Trump and discuss this with him," he told reporters.

Trump responded saying, "He put out a very promising statement but it wasn't complete."

"I'd love to meet with him or talk to him. But we have to get

it (a ceasefire deal) over with fast."

He added that it would be "a very disappointing moment for the world" if Russia rejects the peace plan. "A lot of the details of a final agreement have actually been discussed. Now we're going to see if Russia is there and, if not, it will be a very disappointing moment for the world," Trump said.

Kremlin aide Yuri Ushakov yesterday criticised the US-Ukrainian ceasefire pro-

posal, saying it would just be a "breather" for the Ukrainian military.

Setting out its red lines, Russia ruled out foreign peacekeepers being deployed to Ukraine as part of a ceasefire or long-term security guarantee.

Russia also wants sanctions to be lifted as part of any deal as it grapples with distortions in its economy. Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said Moscow considered the sanctions "illegal". — AFP

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MIDDLE EAST

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IFTAR 18:31

Fajr	05:12	Shuruq	06:26
Dhuhr	12:31	Asr	15:54
Maghrib	18:31	Isha	19:44

IMSAK 05:02

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

Filipina inspires with her journey from housemaid to CEO in UAE

Maria Paz's 7 pastry shops helped fund daughter's medical needs

DUBAI
BY MANUEL ALMARIO
Senior News Editor

Meet Maria Paz Banaag-Marquez, 58, a successful businesswoman and symbol of perseverance.

She raised three children alone and now owns seven thriving pastry shops across the UAE. Her journey showcases the power of love and determination.

Born into a poor family in Quezon Province, Maria Paz was no stranger to struggle. But her journey truly began when she became a mother to Jamaica Mae, a daughter born with multiple disabilities. Jamaica Mae needed surgery to repair her mouth palate, an eye surgery, and later, a heart surgery to address a hole in her heart. Maria Paz's small bakery in her home-



town was simply not enough to cover her daughter's medical needs.

"I didn't have enough money for her heart operations, and it broke my heart," Maria Paz shared.

In 2005, Maria Paz left her children behind and moved to Saudi Arabia to work as a housemaid. In 2008, she moved to Dubai, where she would continue working as a housemaid for a French couple in Umm Suqeim. In 2021, after her employer left, Maria Paz made the bold decision to open a small bakery in Satwa, Dubai — Maria Paz Pastry.

In just four years, Maria Paz became a proud owner of seven pastry shops in the UAE. She spent one million pesos (Dh100,000) for Jamaica Mae's surgeries, all funded by the success of Maria Paz Pastry.

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